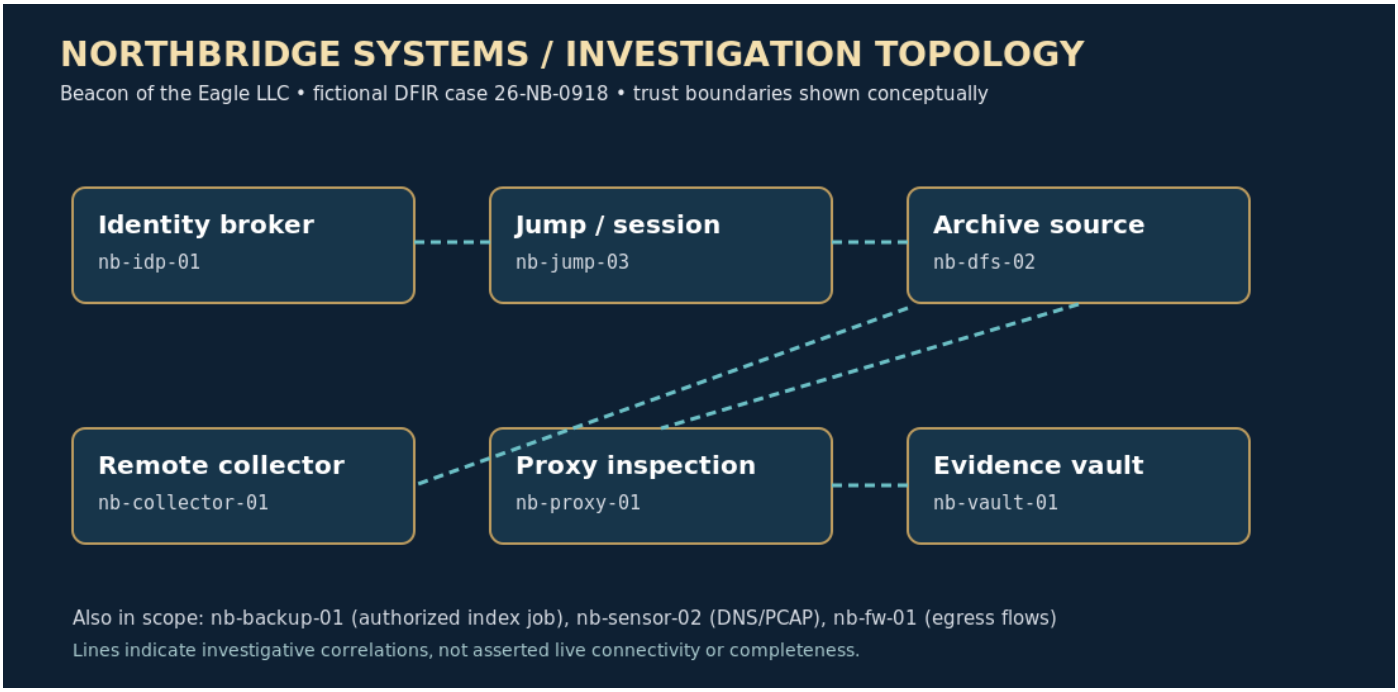
THE LAST EVIDENCE STANDING

PLAYER INVESTIGATION DOSSIER | NO ANSWERS

Case 26-NB-0918 • Northbridge Systems (fictional) • Beacon of the Eagle LLC

Incident brief. A maintenance window overlaps a suspicious restricted-data read, outbound transfer and missing log telemetry. Independent identity, host, network and signed witness exhibits survive. Your mandate is to reconstruct the timeline, audit integrity, exclude benign lookalikes, and avoid unsupported attribution.

Offline quick start. Open README.md , review CASE_BRIEF and NETWORK_DIAGRAM, verify hashes using tools/verify_student.py, then answer Q01-Q30 using exact strings. Optional A-F board exercises support free-form reporting.



Evidence scope: synthetic only. Files include flat CSV, real TAR.GZ, SQLite, PCAP CONNECT slice, detached Ed25519 witness and request-body spool. A signature verifies witness bytes, not human origin or source truth.

I | Why was the archive host touched?

Q01. What is the exact SOC incident identifier that opened this investigation?

Q02. Which hostname is the archive host affected by the missing telemetry?

Q03. Which approved change ticket overlaps the investigated window?

Q04. State the exact approved UTC maintenance window as `HH:MM–HH:MM`.

Q05. Which operation is explicitly approved by the change board? Return its hyphenated operation value.

Q06. Which host actually ran the legitimate scheduled backup-index job?

II | Identity and clock conflict

Q07. Correlate the approved scheduled job with the independent suspicious workload-token record: which exact service principal appears in both, despite the different origin and scope?

Q08. Exclude the approved job token using the asset, issuance time and granted scope. What is the exact anomalous workload token ID?

Q09. Join the anomalous token issuance to an observed jump process without relying on the client device label. Which exact session ID is common to both?

Q10. Which **client-origin** IP does the broker report for that anomalous session?

Q11. What exact certificate-fingerprint *claim* is recorded for the anomalous session?

Q12. Give the raw `observed_host_time` for process `jp-402`, including the date and `Z`.

Q13. After applying the documented jump-host clock offset, give the UTC time of `jp-402`, including the date and `Z`.

III | Staging and outbound bytes

Q14. Starting from the anomalous jump-host session, pivot to the archive-side audit trace. Which full protected source path did that linked export read?

Q15. Using the shared trace rather than a filename keyword, identify the full destination staging path created by the archive process.

Q16. Recompute SHA-256 over the provided physical TAR.GZ bytes and compare with FIM and proxy records. Which 64-character lowercase digest survives all three comparisons?

Q17. Reconcile the physical TAR.GZ file size with the FIM scan and gateway recorded body length. What single integer byte count is shared by all three?

Q18. Which destination hostname received the suspicious inspected POST?

Q19. What is the documented external destination IP associated with that request?

Q20. Exclude the benign update GETs and match the inspected POST to the host-side transfer trace and destination IP. What is its exact gateway request ID?

Q21. Give the *uncorrected* proxy wall-clock timestamp for this POST, including date and `Z`.

Q22. Correct the proxy time to UTC. Give the timestamp including date and `Z`.

IV | Visibility loss

Q23. Among the control-plane revisions, which ID changed `forwarding.enabled` from `true` to `false` and precedes the collector disappearance?

Q24. Compare all observations for the affected host, not the alert-creation time. At which UTC timestamp did the collector first record `missing`?

V | Surviving witness and restoration

Q25. The detached Ed25519 signature must verify under the provided vault public key. What exact `witness_id` is associated with the signed object containing five observation references?

Q26. After the collector impairment, which UTC FIM **scan timestamp** first records a zero-byte `forwarded.log`? Answer in `YYYY-MM-DDTHH:MM:SSZ` format; do not mistake scan time for the time of the truncation command.

Q27. Which exact configuration revision restores `forwarding.enabled` from `false` to `true`?

Q28. What UTC time does the collector first record `healthy` **after** the period of missing heartbeats? Answer in `YYYY-MM-DDTHH:MM:SSZ` format.

Q29. At what exact UTC time does the identity broker record the anomalous token as `revoked`? Answer in `YYYY-MM-DDTHH:MM:SSZ` format.

Q30. Of the change-board's explicit exclusions, which hyphenated operation specifically forbids disabling collector forwarding? Answer the exclusion label exactly as recorded.

OPTIONAL ANALYST BOARD (A-F)

A. Authorization scope vs change approval. Produce an observation / inference / unresolved-evidence grid and cite two independent observations.

B. Byte equality and HTTP 201 proof limits. Produce an observation / inference / unresolved-evidence grid and cite two independent observations.

C. Signature verification vs provenance and authenticity. Produce an observation / inference / unresolved-evidence grid and cite two independent observations.

D. Clock uncertainty and missing-record interval. Produce an observation / inference / unresolved-evidence grid and cite two independent observations.

E. Benign decoy and actor attribution alternatives. Produce an observation / inference / unresolved-evidence grid and cite two independent observations.

F. Incident commander containment and safe restoration. Produce an observation / inference / unresolved-evidence grid and cite two independent observations.

Player reminder: this case deliberately does not establish the real human behind the token, destination human retrieval or independent external PKI validation.